



## META'S NEW SHAH

**META'S \$900-MILLION** bet on CRED is about far more than a minority stake. The deal is expected to give it a 20% holding in the fintech Unicorn and brings founder **Kunal Shah** to the helm of WhatsApp globally. Industry watchers see it as a twin bet on leadership and payments, with Meta seeking deeper inroads into India's digital commerce ecosystem. Despite owning just 20%, Meta could emerge as CRED's single-largest shareholder, underscoring the strategic significance of the investment.

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## UK TRADE TIES ON A HIGH

**OVER A YEAR** after it was signed, the India-UK free trade agreement is set to come into effect from July 15 this year. The two countries managed to iron out last-minute hitches that cropped up after the UK decided to curb tariff-free steel imports with India being assured that 85% of its exports would not face the measures. Meanwhile, India's talks with the US for a bilateral trade deal are well underway. A delegation led by US Trade Representative Ambassador Jamieson Greer visited New Delhi recently. While there's no official word on when the deal will be finalised, the mood remains optimistic.



**12**  
PER CENT

**SURGE IN THE NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 INDEX SINCE THE US-IRAN CONFLICT BEGAN ON FEBRUARY 28. IN COMPARISON, THE NIFTY MIDCAP 150 INDEX GAINED 5%, THE NIFTY 50 INDEX DECLINED 5%**

## A NEW LEASE OF LIFE

**SPICEJET HAS RECEIVED ₹150 crore** from the government's Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme. It is part of the ₹500 crore funding approved for the airline industry to meet challenges due to the West Asia conflict. The money is being used for clearance of three months worth of employees' dues. A total of ₹1,500 crore has been approved for the carriers, but no other airline has received the funds yet.

